Monthly VM update checklist

Public sanitized edition of the September 2026 handout. Historical Alpine 3.23 procedure: verify current vendor guidance and OS support before use. Run each command separately.

1. Back up, then stop the battlegroup

Have a current Funcom backup and a VM recovery copy. Stop the battlegroup normally before updating.

2. Connect from Windows PowerShell

Enter values from your own server profile. Verify SSH host identity; do not bypass a host-key mismatch.

```
$vmAddress = Read-Host 'VM address'
$vmUser = Read-Host 'SSH user'
$vmKey = Read-Host 'SSH key path'
ssh -i $vmKey -o StrictHostKeyChecking=yes "$vmUser@$vmAddress"
```

3. Refresh the update list (inside Linux)

```
sudo /sbin/apk update
```

4. Preview what will change

Stop on errors or unexpected changes. See the longer guide for package-manager updates and branch checks.

```
sudo /sbin/apk upgrade --simulate
```

5. Install the reviewed updates

```
sudo /sbin/apk upgrade
```

6. Review configuration changes

Pause for new or unfamiliar files. Do not automatically replace existing settings.

```
sudo find /etc -name '*.apk-new' -type f
```

7. Reboot the VM

Only after a successful update and configuration review. SSH will disconnect; wait for the VM to return.

```
sudo /sbin/reboot
```

8. Start the battlegroup and verify

Use the manager or Funcom script. Check service/map health, then join the game.

If an update fails, stop before rebooting. OS package updates do not update the game images or separately installed Kubernetes components.